
**Unit 1, Option C,
Topic C4:
Commerce and
Conquest: India,
c1760-c1835**

The focus of this topic is on the activities of the East India Company and Britain as the company sought to extend its influence over the Indian sub-continent, and on the actions and reactions of the indigenous population as well as other Europeans living and working in India. Since the focus of Unit 1 is on broad themes, questions will not be set which concentrate exclusively on depth of knowledge, for example about one particular individual or event, other than those which are specifically listed in the content bullet points. Students will, however, be expected to demonstrate their understanding of the themes defined in the content bullet points by the selection and deployment of relevant information in exemplification.

Collectively, the four bullet points of the specification offer a framework for understanding the themes of the nature, exercise and consolidation of British power in India c1760-c1835. The content bullet points cannot be taken in isolation from one another and students should develop an appreciation of links between them. For example, the power and influence of the East India Company (bullet 1) impacts upon the relationship of British and French in India (bullet 2), while the opposition of Tipu Sahib (bullet 3) relates directly to the activities of the governor generalships of Cornwallis and Hastings (bullet 4).

The first bullet point relates to the nature of the power and influence that the East India Company exercised on the Indian sub-continent, and this can be illustrated by reference to the Madras, Bombay and Bengal presidencies. Students need to be aware of why various British governments attempted to curb the power of the company. Knowledge of specific clauses of the Acts listed in the content bullet points will not be required but students will be expected to use the reasons for, and outcomes of, the Acts in exemplification of the broad theme of power and control.

The second bullet point relates to the interaction of the British with other Europeans on the Indian sub-continent, as exemplified by the relationship between the British and French. Students should be aware of the ways in which Anglo-French trading rivalry developed in India and they need to understand that Anglo-French conflict in Europe, as illustrated by the Seven Years War, impacted on the Anglo-French rivalry in India, where the battles led by Dupleix and Clive further exemplify this theme of Anglo-French conflict. Questions will not be set which focus exclusively and specifically on events or individuals not given in the content bullet points.

The third bullet point relates to the interaction of the British with the indigenous Indian population in particular with the Indian princes, and can be addressed through examples of the ways in which Indian princes sought to limit the power of the British in the declining years of Mughal rule. This theme of the relationship between the British and the Indian princes can be illustrated by the opposition of Tipu Sahib in Mysore, relations with the Marathas and the Mysore Wars. Questions will not be set on specific wars or individuals not mentioned in the content bullet points but students will be expected to appreciate and exemplify the way in which relationships between the British and the Indian princes changed and developed as British power and influence spread.